TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 14, 2024
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6 pm.

Nicholas Patrick, 2821 Grant Street, presented from a handout discussing the Thunderbolt Community Improvement Association's desire to rezone the current I-P parcels to R-1 to preserve the neighborhood feeling in the area.

Geneva Golden, 3126 Gilbert Street, discussed the leaning trees near her house and other houses nearby. She stated during the storm a tree fell into a line that is still hanging low. She also stated she would like to have a discussion about overgrowth in easements and alleys.

Sue DeRosa, 3216 Bannon Drive, stated the last tree inventory was done in 2012. She stated the Town needed to apply for a grant to get a new direct inventory done of the trees in Thunderbolt.

Ms. Golden stated the house across from the SSU gate has 2 pit-bulls not on leashes. She stated the house needs to be condemned. She also stated the house next to it needs to be condemned too.

Chief Clayton stated that Code Enforcement is aware and has been in contact with the out-of-state owner.

Ms. Yvonne, 3116 Falligant Avenue, stated the house in question has been like that for over 1 year. Dogs are always on the loose. Nothing new- it's an ongoing problem.
Mayor Williams closed the public comment at 6:29 pm.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order** - Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:38 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In Attendance is Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Lawrence Ward, Bethany Skipper-Greer, David Crenshaw, Edward Drohan, James Lavin, and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Police Chief, Sean Clayton, Police Lieutenant, Brandon Runyon; Fire Captain, Josh Mohler; Director of Public Works, Oscar Crosby; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Accounts Payable Manager, Katina Spaulding; Utility Clerk, Renee Holmes; Town Clerk/Zoning Administrator/Town Administrator, Matthew Walker.

3. **Approval of Amended Meeting Agenda (moving item 8a to 6b, moving item 7c to 7a, tabling item 7e)**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve the amended agenda with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:

   Minutes of July 10, 2024

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes of July 10, 2024. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the meeting minutes of July 10, 2024 with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motions passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentation:**

   a) Mayor Williams read the "Know Local-Go Local" business spotlight for September 2024. The businesses recognized in September are: Luminary Salon, Savannah Wildlife Rescue Center, Ali-Gaitor Marine Works, and Precision Firearms.

6. **Finance Report:**

   Ms. Shannon Brett of HBBB reviewed the finance report for July 2024. She stated the audit is done and we are waiting on our Certificate of Excellence.

   Ms. Brett also discussed the interest rates and balances of Thunderbolt investments. She stated the United Community Bank interest rate dropped from 4.75% to 4.38%. The money market and SPLOST accounts are still at 4.75%.

7. **Consent Agenda:**

   Mayor Williams closed the regular session to open a public hearing at 7:12pm

   Zoning Administrator Walker explained the history of the request. Bob Portman, representative for Bryan Ray, stated they listened to the community and amended their request.

   a) Consideration to rezone property from (I-P) to (R-1)
      Applicant: Bryan Ray
      Address: 4549 Whatley Ave
      PIN(s): 30292 02013 & 30292 02011

   Mayor Williams closed the public hearing and opened the regular session at 7:17pm

   A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve items 7a and 7d with a second from Council Member Barbaree. The motion passed unanimously.

   b) Approval of Downing Street Lift Station Surge Protector purchase

   c) Approval of Downing Street Lift Station Panel replacement purchase

   d) Consideration to combine lots (combining 2 lots into 1 lot)
      Applicant: Bryan Ray
      Address: 4549 Whatley Ave
      PIN(s): 30292 02013 & 30292 02011

   e) Approval of Standard Repair Agreement for elevator

A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve the remaining items on the consent agenda. Council Member Barbaree provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

   a) Town of Thunderbolt investments

   This item was moved to item 6b. Council Member Crenshaw made a motion to form an ad-hoc committee with the ability to move forward with investments with the condition that all changes are to be reported immediately to all council members and announced at the next council meeting. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

   by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police
   Chief Clayton added that Blueline Solutions crew will be coming next week to fix the issues with the school cameras. He had nothing further to add.

   Fire –Fire Captain, Josh Mohler
   Captain Mohler had nothing to add to his report.

   Public Works Department – Director of Public Works, Oscar Crosby
   Director Crosby was not present to review his report due to work needs

10. **Town Clerk/Town Administrator Report** – Matthew Walker

    Town Clerk/Administrator Walker announced the hiring of Elizabeth Rhoades as Executive Assistant to the Town Administrator. He also stated the Town will be moving some accounts payable to ACH payments for efficiency. He had nothing further to add.

11. **Legal Report** – Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow

    Nothing to report or discuss

12. **Mayor and Council** –

    Hyundai Metaplant Water impact – Dr. Drohan explained the water issue with the Hyundai plant and how it will impact this area more than originally expected. The Town of Thunderbolt needs to look to the future and plan ahead so we are prepared.

13. **Thunderbolt Museum**

    Anna Maria Thomas discussed the yard sale on 9/14/24. The museum is getting some renovations, including a wall to preserve history. They will announce a re-grand opening once more information is available.

14. **Executive Session-**

    Council Member Ward made a motion at 7:50 pm to leave regular session to enter executive session to discuss Personnel, Property, or Litigation. Council Member Barbaree seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

    Council Member Crenshaw made a motion at 8:08 pm to leave executive session to return to regular session. Council Member Drohan seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

    Mayor Williams discussed the old Fire Truck "Ginny" that is at the shop for restoration.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

15. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:10 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Town Clerk